Interviews were conducted with a number of leading journalists and reporters who dealt with security issues, to ascertain if any TTP spokesman had ever talked to them directly or if they knew any journalist who had ever come in contact with any TTP spokesman.[6] None of them admitted to have direct contact. It was learnt from them that the TTP spokesperson preferred to talk to Pashtun journalists. Reportedly, the well-known journalist Rahimullah Yusufzai, Resident Editor, *The News International*, KP, used to get calls from the TTP spokesperson and TTP militant leaders too. Amir Mir, the author of *Talibanization of Pakistan*, confirmed that TTP's genuine spokesperson called the journalists of their choice and trust.

Those journalists also knew the spokesperson's identity but of course not their location. He added that the TTP spokesperson preferred to call the journalists affiliated with Reuters, BBC and Associated Press in order to get coverage in all newspapers and TV channels. He was of the opinion that Ashfaq Yusufzai, award-winning journalist working with *The News International*, and Munir Ahmed were usually contacted by the TTP spokesperson and militants.

TTP also sent emails to media organisations, which were often followed by the confirmation by telephone calls from the TTP spokesperson. Ehsanullah Ehsan, the TTP spokesperson, sent an email to *The News* to give the TTP reaction over the killing of Muslims in Myanmar (*The News International*, 2012). Saleem Safi, a columnist and Geo TV anchor, and a Pashtun by race, also received an email from TTP spokesperson Ehsanullah Ehsan to react on his comments in a popular Geo TV talk show 'Aaj Kamran Khan Kay Sath' (with *Kamran Khan Today*). "It is included in our demands, but our first and last demand is implementation of the *Sharia* law in Pakistan, instead of secular and democratic laws. After implementation of *Sharia*, relations with America will end as well, as Islam prohibits us from making *kuffar* (non-believers) our friends and the Qur'an clearly guides us about this. Hopefully you have understood our stance and next time you will keep it in consideration while making statement about the TTP" (Safi, 2012).

Mr Saleem Safi, while commenting in the talk show 'Aaj Kamran Khan Kay Sath' on 9-7-2012 made a statement that if Pakistan had tried to commence talks with the TTP during the time of the closure of supplies, it could have resulted in a better situation as it was a major